

Ranged Combat Maneuvers

Firing a bow or a gun from behind a wall may not be as heroic as charging into battle, sword held high, but it's often a great deal safer and at least as effective.

Aiming: Taking time to precisely aim a weapon increases the attacker's chance to hit. The attacker adds one die to her attack dice pool for every turn she spends aiming her weapon before using it. If the weapon has a scope, add an additional two dice (for a total of +3 dice) for the first turn of aiming. The maximum bonus a character can earn from aiming equals her Perception (+2 additional dice for a scope). Only characters with at least one dot in Firearms can aim. Attackers can perform no other actions or perform multiple actions while aiming. Attackers cannot successfully aim at any target moving faster than a walk.

Automatic Fire: The attacker empties the weapon's entire clip at a single target. This maneuver can only be used with weapons capable of automatic fire when the weapon's clip is at least half full. Automatic fire adds 10 dice to the shooter's attack pool. However, the massive recoil produced increases the attack's difficulty by 2. Automatic fire cannot be combined with targeted attacks. The weapon is out of ammunition after using this maneuver and must be reloaded. Damage is rolled normally, but is typically quite high due to the many added successes.

Roll: Dexterity + Firearms **Difficulty:** +2

Accuracy: +10 **Damage:** Weapon damage

Reloading: Reloading takes an entire action but does not require a roll; it counts as an automatic action. It can be performed as part of a multiple action without penalty.

Strafing: Automatic weapons can also be used to spray bullets across an entire area. Like normal automatic fire, strafing also adds 10 dice to the character's attack pool, adds 2 to the difficulty, requires the weapon's magazine to be at least half full, and empties the weapon's magazine. Characters can cover up to three yards/meters with bullets using this maneuver. The attacker divides all her successes equally between everyone in the area. Even if only one person is in the area, no target can receive more than half the total successes and, if there are more targets than successes, the Storyteller decides who gets missed.

Roll: Dexterity + Firearms **Difficulty:** +2

Accuracy: +10 **Damage:** Weapon damage

Three-Round Burst: Many automatic weapons can also be set to fire only three bullets at once. This maneuver adds 2 dice to the character's attack pool and uses up three shots. The increased recoil adds 1 to the attack's difficulty.

Roll: Dexterity + Firearms **Difficulty:** +1

Accuracy: +2 **Damage:** Weapon damage

Thrown Weapons: Some weapons are designed to be thrown, and anyone can throw a rock or a bottle. Such attacks are treated as ranged weapons, but their range is much lower and attackers cannot use any of the above maneuvers, including aiming. Weapons not designed to be thrown impose a +1 difficulty to the attack roll, which may become +2 for especially unwieldy weapons. Thrown weapons have a base difficulty of 6 for both normal and point-blank attacks (see Range below).

Roll: Dexterity + Athletics **Difficulty:** 6 or higher

Accuracy: +0 **Damage:** Weapon damage

Ranged Combat Complications

Cover: The best way to remain unharmed when bullets or arrows are flying is to have something solid between you and them. Cover adds to the attacker's difficulty of hitting his target. The better cover the target has, the greater the added difficulty. Complete cover prevents all attacks. However, only cowards, non-combatants, and characters who are hopelessly outmatched simply hide from an attack without attempting to return fire. Characters who are hidden behind complete cover must leave this cover and stick at least their face and hand out to attack. Also, working to keep as much of yourself behind cover as possible means you can't fire as effectively as if you weren't worrying about remaining behind cover. The increased difficulties for attacking someone behind cover and attacking from behind cover are listed below.

Cover Type	Difficulty to Hit Target Behind Cover	Difficulty to Fire from Cover
Light (lying prone)	+1	+0
Good (behind wall)	+2	+1
Superior (only head and hand exposed)	+3	+2

Movement: The easiest way to shoot a gun or bow is to remain relatively still while doing so. Unfortunately, that also makes you an excellent target. Moving while shooting is more difficult, but also safer. Characters who move while firing suffer a +1 difficulty to their ranged attack pools, but anyone firing a ranged weapon at them also suffers a +1 difficulty to hit them.

Range: The Ranged Weapons Chart (see p. 287) lists each weapon's medium range; attacks made at that range are made at difficulty 6. The weapon's maximum range is twice its medium range. Attacks made up to maximum range are made at difficulty 8. Attacks made at targets within two meters/yards are considered point-blank range and are made at difficulty 4. However, as mentioned above, attacks with thrown weapons are made at difficulty 6 for both point-blank and medium range attacks.

Phase Three: Defense

All characters in combat who aren't surprised or immobilized attempt to evade harm. However, when characters are busy concentrating on attacking or performing some other action, this defense is considerably less effective than if they take an action to specifically avoid being hit. You have four options for declaring a defense. You can state at the beginning of the turn that your character will be defending, you can split your actions between a defense and one or more other actions, you can delay your character's initiative and then choose to use your action for defense, or you can abort your previously-chosen action to a defense.

Players have a choice of three different types of defensive maneuvers: blocks, dodges, and parries. These three options